PEW RESEARCH CENTER
August 16-19, 2012 OMNIBUS
FINAL TOPLINE
N=1,005

ASK ALL:

PEW.1 As I read a list of some stories covered by news organizations this past week, please tell me if you happened to follow each news story very closely, fairly closely, not too closely, or not at all closely. First, **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE;] [IF NECESSARY** "Did you follow **[ITEM]** very closely, fairly closely, not too closely or not at all closely?"**]**

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. Reports about the condition of the U.S. economy					
August 16-19, 2012	33	32	16	19	*
August 9-12, 2012	30	31	20	18	1
August 2-5, 2012	33	29	20	17	1
July 26-29, 2012	32	30	20	19	*
July 19-22, 2012	39	29	16	16	*
July 12-15, 2012	32	33	18	17	1
July 5-8, 2012	34	28	18	19	1
June 28-July 1, 2012	38	28	15	18	1
June 21-24, 2012	33	32	17	17	*
June 14-17, 2012	39	28	15	17	*
June 7-10, 2012	35	32	15	18	*
May 31-June 3, 2012	37	34	13	14	1
May 24-27, 2012	33	31	19	16	1
May 17-20, 2012	35	30	16	19	*
May 10-13, 2012	40	26	16	17	*
May 3-6, 2012	38	29	13	20	*
April 26-29, 2012	34	32	17	16	1
April 19-22, 2012	35	35	13	14	2
April 12-15, 2012	39	28	16	17	1
April 5-8, 2012	37	31	16	16	1
March 29-April 1, 2012	34	33	15	18	1
March 22-25, 2012	36	29	16	18	1
March 15-18, 2012	40	35	11	14	1
March 8-11, 2012	37	32	14	17	*
March 1-4, 2012	41	27	15	17	1
February 23-26, 2012	37	33	14	15	1
February 16-20, 2012	33	32	16	17	1
February 9-12, 2012	42	30	14	13	1
February 2-5, 2012	38	32	16	13	1
January 26-29, 2012	35	31	16	19	*
January 19-22, 2012	35	30	16	19	1
January 12-15, 2012	33	32	14	20	1
January 5-8, 2012	39	31	15	15	*
December 15-18, 2011	36	32	14	16	1
December 8-11, 2011	41	29	13	16	1
December 1-4, 2011	40	33	13	13	1
November 17-20, 2011	35	33	16	15	1
November 10-13, 2011	39	31	15	14	*
November 3-6, 2011	37	31	15	17	1
October 27-30, 2011	38	33	14	15	1
October 20-23, 2011	38	32	14	16	1
October 13-16, 2011	39	32	14	14	*
October 6-9, 2011	43	28	14	14	1
September 29-October 2, 2011	46	26	14	14	*
September 22-25, 2011	44	33	11	11	*
September 8-11, 2011	40	30	15	14	1
September 1-4, 2011	44	30	11	15	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
August 25-28, 2011	44	28	14	13	1
August 18-21, 2011	44	29	12	14	1
August 4-7, 2011	46	30	11	13	1
July 28-31, 2011	43	30	13	13	*
July 21-24, 2011	41	32	13	13	1
July 14-17, 2011	41	30	14	14	1
July 7-10, 2011	36	30	15	18	1
June 30-July 3, 2011	38	32	13	16	1
June 23-26, 2011	37	29	15	19	*
June 16-19, 2011	39	33	14	13	*
June 9-12, 2011	39	30	15	16	1
June 2-5, 2011	35	34	17	14	*
May 19-22, 2011	33	34	17	16	*
May 12-15, 2011	32	32	17	18	2
May 5-8, 2011	40	35	15	9	1
April 21-25, 2011	41	33	12	14	*
April 14-17, 2011	44	30	14	12	1
April 7-10, 2011	46	30	14	10	*
March 31-April 3, 2011	42	31	16	11	0
March 24-27, 2011	36	32	17	15	*
March 17-20, 2011	38	32	17	13	*
March 10-13, 2011	40	30	16	13	*
March 3-6, 2011	37	31	17	13	1
February 24-27, 2011	49	29	11	10	*
February 17-20, 2011	35	33	14	17	*
February 10-13, 2011	36	34	13	16	*
February 3-6, 2011	35	37	14	14	*
January 20-23, 2011	37	33	14	15	1
January 13-16, 2011	37	29	15	18	1
January 6-9, 2011	39	37	11	12	1

SEE TRENDS FOR PREVIOUS YEARS: http://www.people-press.org/files/2011/11/NII-Economy-Trends.pdf

b. Political violence in Syria

August 16-19, 2012	12	24	26	37	2
July 19-22, 2012	17	24	23	36	1
June 28-July 1, 2012	13	19	26	42	*
June 14-17, 2012	15	24	21	40	1
May 31-June 3, 2012	12	25	25	37	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
April 12-15, 2012: *International efforts to stop political violence in Syria*	14	23	25	37	1
April 5-8, 2012	15	21	27	37	1
March 15-28, 2012: *Political violence in Syria*	16	26	27	30	1
March 8-11, 2012	17	23	23	37	1
February 23-26, 2012	18	24	21	35	1
February 9-12, 2012	17	23	23	36	*
January 12-15, 2012	12	17	26	45	1
August 4-7, 2011: *Political violence following uprisings in Syria*	10	19	26	44	1
May 5-8, 2011	14	27	30	28	1
June 2-5, 2011: *Anti-government protests and violence in some Middle Eastern countries*	18	25	25	32	*
April 28-May 1, 2011	18	29	25	27	1
February 3-6, 2011: *Anti-government protests in Egypt and other Middle Eastern countries*	32	35	16	18	*
January 27-30, 2011	17	26	21	35	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
c. News about candidates for the 2012 presidential election					
August 16-19, 2012	32	27	19	22	1
August 9-12, 2012	27	27	21	24	1
August 2-5, 2012	31	25	19	23	1
July 26-29, 2012	25	28	21	25	1
July 19-22, 2012	35	22	17	25	1
July 12-15, 2012	33	24	20	23	*
July 5-8, 2012	29	26	20	25	*
June 28-July 1, 2012	32	24	19	25	*
June 21-24, 2012	27	30	17	25	1
June 14-17, 2012	31	30	15	24	*
June 7-10, 2012	30	29	16	25	1
May 31-June 3, 2012	29	28	19	23	1
May 24-27, 2012	32	28	16	24	1
May 17-20, 2012	31	26	19	23	*
May 10-13, 2012	34	23	18	24	*
May 3-6, 2012	29	27	19	24	*
April 26-29, 2012	29	29	18	23	1
April 19-22, 2012	29	29	20	20	1
April 12-15, 2012	32	28	16	23	1
April 5-8, 2012	31	27	18	23	*
March 29-April 1, 2012	23	29	21	27	*
March 22-25, 2012	28	28	18	25	1
March 15-18, 2012	28	31	17	24	*
March 8-11, 2012	28	27	21	23	*
March 1-4, 2012	31	24	20	24	1
February 23-26, 2012	28	29	18	24	1
February 16-20, 2012	25	29	19	25	2
February 9-12, 2012	35	25	18	20	1
February 2-5, 2012	30	27	20	21	1
January 26-29, 2012	28	30	21	21	1
January 19-22, 2012	28	30	17	24	*
January 12-15, 2012	29	29	18	23	1
January 5-8, 2012	29	30	16	25	*
December 15-18, 2011	26	24	20	29	1
December 8-11, 2011	27	27	18	28	*
December 1-4, 2011	25	28	20	26	1
November 17-20, 2011	24	31	21	23	1
November 3-6, 2011	22	31	20	26	1
October 27-30, 2011	21	26	21	30	1
October 20-23, 2011	21	28	22	28	1
October 13-16, 2011	26	29	22	23	1
October 6-9, 2011	25	25	23	27	1
September 29-October 2, 2011	27	26	21	25	*
September 22-25, 2011	25	26	23	25	1
September 15-18, 2011	24	28	21	27	1
September 8-11, 2011	22	26	21	31	*
September 1-4, 2011	22	23	22	32	1
August 25-28, 2011	22	22	22	33	1
August 18-21, 2011	27	26	19	28	1
August 11-14, 2011	19	24	20	36	1
August 4-7, 2011	18	21	22	37	1
July 28-31, 2011	17	27	21	35	1
July 21-24, 2011	17	22	28	32	*
July 14-17, 2011	18	26	27	28	1
July 7-10, 2011	16	23	27	33	1
June 30-July 3, 2011	21	28	24	25	2
June 23-26, 2011	19	26	24	31	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
June 16-19, 2011	23	29	23	25	*
June 9-12, 2011	18	30	22	30	1
June 2-5, 2011	21	31	22	26	*
May 26-29, 2011	20	27	24	28	*
May 19-22, 2011	15	27	24	32	1
May 12-15, 2011	15	22	26	35	1
May 5-8, 2011	16	24	27	32	1
April 21-25, 2011	18	26	23	32	1
April 14-17, 2011	20	23	29	27	1
March 24-27, 2011	13	19	26	41	1
March 10-13, 2011	15	21	26	38	0
February 10-13, 2011	16	19	24	40	*
February 3-6, 2011	15	20	23	42	*

SEE TRENDS FOR PREVIOUS YEARS: http://www.people-press.org/files/2011/11/NII-Election-Trends.pdf

ASK ALL:
Next,
PEW.2 How would you rate the job Joe Biden has done as vice president? Has he done an excellent, good, only fair, or poor job as vice president?

Aug 16-19 2012	
7	Excellent
20	Good
31	Only fair
25	Poor
17	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

ASK ALL:
Thinking about the presidential campaign…
PEW.3 How much, if anything, have you heard about Mitt Romney's choice of a vice presidential running mate? Have you heard a lot, a little or nothing at all?

		TRENDS FOR COMPARISON	
		McCain's choice	*Obama's choice*
Aug 16-19		Aug 29-31	Aug 22-25
2012		2008	2008
42	A lot	56	58
37	A little	30	35
20	Nothing at all	13	7
1	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	1	*

ASK ALL:
PEW.4 As you may have heard Mitt Romney has named Paul Ryan as his running mate. How would you rate Paul Ryan? Do you think he is an excellent, good, only fair, or poor choice?

		TRENDS FOR COMPARISON	
		Edwards	*Gore*
Aug 16-19		July	July
2012		2004	1992
14	Excellent	16	15
14	Good	33	25
23	Only fair	22	22
22	Poor	9	5
26	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	20	33

NO QUESTIONS PEW.5-PEW.6

Next,
ASK ALL:
PEW.7 What is more important, taking steps to reduce the budget deficit or keeping Social Security and Medicare benefits as they are?

Aug 16-19 2012		Sep 22-Oct 4 2011	Jun 15-19 2011	Feb 1995
33	Taking steps to reduce the budget deficit	35	32	24
51	Keeping Social Security and Medicare benefits as they are	58	60	70
11	Both equally **(VOL.)**	2	4	2
5	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	4	5	4

ASK ALL:
Next,
PEJ.1 Does the phrase **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE]** better describe **[RANDOMIZE:** Barack Obama, Mitt Romney**]** or don't you think it describes either of them? How about **[NEXT ITEM]**? **[IF NECESSARY:** "Does the phrase **[ITEM]** better describe **[IN SAME ORDER AS FIRST MENTION:** Barack Obama, Mitt Romney**]** or don't you think it describes either of them?**]**

	Obama	Romney	Neither	**(VOL.)** Both	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. He has good moral character					
August 16-19, 2012	38	22	18	14	8
b. He is an out-of-touch elitist					
August 16-19, 2012	22	31	28	6	13
c. He believes in American values					
August 16-19, 2012	37	26	18	12	7
d. He has the wrong approach to fixing the economy					
August 16-19, 2012	32	29	24	6	8
e. He often makes mistakes when he speaks					
August 16-19, 2012	17	30	28	13	12
f. He has the best experience to be a good leader					
August 16-19, 2012	40	25	23	3	9

ASK ALL:
PEW.8 As you may know, Medicare is the government program that provides health care to seniors and people with permanent disabilities. How much, if anything, have you heard about a proposal to change Medicare into a program that would give future participants a credit toward purchasing private health insurance coverage? Have you heard a lot, a little, or nothing at all?

Aug 16-19 2012		May 25-30 2011
30	A lot	20
42	A little	50
28	Nothing at all	28
1	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	1

ASK ALL:

PEW.9 Generally, do you favor or oppose this proposal? **[REPEAT PROPOSAL AS NEEDED:** Would you favor or oppose a proposal to change Medicare into a program that would give future participants a credit toward purchasing private health insurance coverage?**]**

ASK IF FAVOR OR OPPOSE (PEW.9=1,2):

PEW.9a Would you say you **[**Favor/Oppose**]** this proposal strongly, or not so strongly?

Aug 16-19 2012		May 25-30 2011
32	Favor	36
19	Strongly	22
12	Not so strongly	13
1	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	1
44	Oppose	41
29	Strongly	30
13	Not so strongly	10
1	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	1
24	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**	23

ASK IF HEARD A LOT/A LITTLE (PEW.8=1,2) [N=780]:

PEW.10 Do you happen to know who proposed this change to Medicare? **[OPEN END; DO NOT READ PRECODES. DO NOT PROBE FOR ADDITIONAL RESPONSES]**

Aug 16-19 2012	
23	Paul Ryan
13	Mitt Romney
17	Barack Obama
3	Other
44	Don't know/Refused